MIL-H-1048G
4 March 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-1048F
29 September 1972

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HAMBURGER PATTIES WITH NATURAL JUICES, CANNED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers canned hamburgers without gravy for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-C-29 - Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging Of.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of metal cans for Subsistence Items.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specification for Fresh Beef Series 100

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Livestock, Meat, Grain and Seed Division, 14th Street and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issues of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

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ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Beef. The beef shall be from steers, heifers, or cows and shall be derived from any combination of the following recognizable primal and sub-primal cuts: square-cut chucks, shoulder clods, chuck rolls, ribs, ribeyes, trimmed full loins, trimmed short loins, strip loins, sirloins, top sirloin butts, rounds, top rounds, knuckles, and bottom rounds. Recognizable cuts are those which, when compared to Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) cuts, have no more than a minor amount of lean, fat, or bone removed or included from an adjacent cut. All suitable lean meat shall be used except tenderloins and may be excluded at the option of the contractor. The beef shall be in the fresh-chilled state and shall be in excellent condition, i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class, grade, and cut of meat, and typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled. Cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show not more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity. The fat shall show no more than a very slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity. No odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present. Changes in color and odor characteristically associated with vacuum-packaged meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable. Also, the meat shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling.

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3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. The beef shall be boned and trimmed to remove objectionable material such as bone, cartilage, heavy connective tissue, etc. The boneless trimmed beef shall meet the limitations specified in tables I and II.

3.2.1.2 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed beef prior to processing into the finished product shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Beef processed on the day of initial certification shall be held in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F (inclusive).

b. Holding in the fresh chilled state for not more than 4 days after certification is permitted provided that the beef is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F (inclusive).

c. Holding raw beef in the frozen state for not more than 120 days is permitted provided that the beef is:

- placed in the freezer within 4 hours after certification
- frozen to 0°F or lower within 72 hours after placement in the freezer
- stored to 0°F or lower
- held for not more than 90 days
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence
- held after storage at an internal temperature not to exceed 40°F when further processing is resumed.

3.2.2 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride, with or without anti-caking agents.

3.1.3.1 Pepper, black, ground. The ground black pepper shall have been ground from the deep brown to black, deep-set, wrinkled, immature berries of Piper nigrum L. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic penetrating odor, a hot biting, pungent flavor, and a light gray to speckled black-gray color. The ground pepper shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 16 sieve.

3.2.4.2 Flavoring, pepper, soluble. Soluble pepper flavoring shall have a pungent aroma and shall contain not less than 4-1/2 percent of total extractive of black pepper.

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made. tank is already installed and current requirement tests have been

3.2.5 Fat frying. Frying fat, if used, shall be prepared from animal or vegetable (excluding coconut oil) or a combination of animal and vegetable fats, which have been hydrogenated and deodorized. The frying fat shall have a clean bland flavor. The frying fat may be liquid or plasticized, may be liquid or plasticized, may contain anti-oxidants in combinations and amounts allowed by FDA, and shall contain antifoaming agents. The fat shall have a maximum free fatty acid content of 0.05 percent (oleic), and stability of not less than 40 hours (A.O.M.), and a smoke point of not less than 400°F.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Preparation and processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Beef patty preparation.

a. The boned and trimmed beef shall be ground initially through a plate having holes 3/4 inch in diameter (or the beef may otherwise be reduced in size so as to insure uniform distribution of the dry ingredients). The mixed ingredients shall be in the quantities specified below:

Beef	100 pounds
Salt	1.25 pounds
Black pepper or equivalent black pepper flavoring	1.50 ounces

b. The prepared hamburger mixture shall be ground through a 3/16 inch plate, and formed into patties.

c. The preformed patties shall be cooked within 4 hours after completion of the final grind and the maximum internal temperature of the patties shall not be allowed to exceed 50°F during this interval.

3.3.2 Cooking of the patties. The patties shall be sufficiently cooked to brown the outer surfaces by any method except moist heat. Frying fat, if used, shall be filtered at least daily and the system cleaned at least once a week. The fat shall be discarded when foaming becomes a problem, or when undesirable odors or flavors develop.

3.4 Can filling and sealing. Each can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with five partially cooked beef patties such as to conform to the finished product requirements. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under vacuum at such level as to result in a final vacuum of not less than 5 inches.

3.5 Can thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6.0 has been achieved. The cans shall be retorted within 8 hours after initial grinding of the bonned and trimmed beef.

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3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. No individual can shall contain less than 8.5 ounces drained weight of hamburger patties.

e. No individual patty within a can shall weigh less than 1.5 ounces or be more than 1 inch in thickness.

f. The average net weight shall be not less than 12.0 ounces.

g. No individual can shall contain less than 11.5 ounces.

h. The fat content shall be not greater than 15.0 percent.

i. The salt content shall be not greater than 1.3 percent nor less than 0.5 percent.

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The beef component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the USDA.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

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4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Beef examination for condition and cut. All beef shall be examined in either the bone-in or boneless state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.2.1. Cuts initially examined in the boneless recognizable cuts. Any nonconforming beef shall be rejected.

4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed beef examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing or to any freezing, the beef shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of pounds shall be declared to the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample size shall be as specified in table I. If all or a portion of the sample unit falls within a larger cut, the entire cut shall be examined. Failure of the beef to meet the acceptance criteria as indicated in table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for beef rejected because of freezing, defrosting, or not being in excellent condition, the beef may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Beef shall not be reexamined more than one time.

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TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed beef

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. sample units)	Defect categories Major AC	Major RE	Minor AC	Minor RE
500 or less	13	1	2	3	4
501 to 1200	20	2	3	5	6
1201 to 3200	32	3	4	7	8
3201 to 10000	50	5	6	10	11
10001 to 35000	80	7	8	14	15
Reinspection lots of 10001 to 35000	125	10	11	21	22

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Presence of popliteal, prescapular, prefemoral, or any lymph gland measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
102		Presence of blood clot measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	201	Presence of blood clot measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
103		Presence of bruise measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	202	Presence of bruise measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
104		Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
105		Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
106		Presence of backstrap or other ligament measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).

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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	203	Presence of backstrap measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
107		Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or the gracilis membrane) measuring 2.0 square inch or more.
	204	Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or the gracilis membrane) measuring 0.5 square inches or more but less than 2.0 square inches.
	205	Presence of heavy connective tissue on lower edge of short plate or flank.
	206	Presence of heavy connective (abdominal tunic) tissue on the flank measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	207	Presence of membranous portion of diaphragm or membranous covering from skirt, flank, or abdominal section of short plate measuring 3.0 square inches or more.
108		Presence of knuckle cover.
109		Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, prepubic tendon, thymus gland, or hanging tender measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).

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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	208	Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, prepubic tendon, thymus gland, or hanging tender measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
	209	Presence of calcified (scratchy) periosteum measuring 2.0 square inches or more.
	210	Presence of shank, clod, knuckle, or bottom (outside) round with tendinous end showing less than 75 percent lean tissue on a cross-sectional cut surface.
	211	Presence of dehydrated surface measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	212	Presence of discolored meat (including blood discolored neck meat) measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	213	Presence of exposed blood vessel measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	214	Presence of cod, udder, kidney, or pelvic fat.

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting or product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

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4.5.1.3 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, US Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such supplier-furnished valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.1.4 Unfilled can inspection. Inspection of unfilled cans shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review or records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled can inspection. The inspection lot shall include only product produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan in table III. The net weight of the filled and sealed cans shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty can and lid. Any individual net weight of less than 11.5 ounces shall be scored as a defect. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 12.0 ounces.

TABLE III. Sampling plan for net weight inspection

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 150	5	0	1
151 to 500	8	0	1
501 to 3200	13	1	2
3201 to 35,000	20	1	2
35,001 to 150,000	32	2	3

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4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan in table IV. The filled and sealed cans shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. Each can in the sample shall be opened, and the contents emptied into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the can's volume of 180° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated so as to liquify rendered fat and physically separate the hamburger patties without breaking the patties. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/2 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the hamburgers over the sieve without breaking the patties. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted slightly and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The separated hamburger patties shall be inspected in accordance with table V. The sample unit shall be the contents of one can.

TABLE IV. Sampling plan for product inspection

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Defect categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
0 to 150	3	0	1	0	1
151 to 1200	5	0	1	1	2
1201 to 35,000	8	0	1	1	2
35,001 to 150,000	13	0	1	2	3

TABLE V. Product defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		More or less than five patties per can.
	201	Individual patty weighing less than 1.5 ounces.
	202	Individual patty thickness greater than 1.0 inch.

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TABLE V. Product defects 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
102		Drained weight of hamburger patties in a can less than 8.5 ounces. 2/
103		Presence of bone greater than 0.3 inch in any dimension. 3/
104		Average net weight less than 12.0 ounces.
105		Individual can contains less than 11.5 ounces.
	203	Presence of ligaments, cartilage, tendon, or connective tissue measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension. 3/

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

3/ Defects shall be scored only once per sample unit.

4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. The product shall be tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the meat and Meat Products Chapter of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. The finding of a test result failing to conform to the fat and salt content requirements in 3.6 shall cause rejection of the lot. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. The sample unit shall be a 1-pound composite of product derived from the number of cans indicated by inspection level S-2.

4.5.4 Packaging examination. Examination of preservation, packing, unit loads, leakage and vacuum shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29. For level A and B packing; other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible shall be classified as a minor B defect.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A.

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve ounces of the product shall be unit packed into a size 300 x 407 can in accordance with the level A requirements of PPP-C-29. The filled and sealed cans shall have a vacuum of not less than 5 inches when tested in accordance with PPP-C-29.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A, B, or C packing. The product shall be packed for each level of protection in accordance with PPP-C-29 for the level specified (see 6.1).

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.1, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with PPP-C-29.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the label shall contain the following information:

HAMBURGER PATTIES

TO HEAT

Pan brown or

Submerge can in boiling water or

Place OPEN can over flame (avoid burning or overheating)

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5.4.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with PPP-C-29.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1, and 6.3).
d. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specified item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUP INST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Beef
Canned foods
Hamburgers

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-H-1048G	Hamburger Patties With Natural Juices, Canned

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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